

7.5.1. Set Up A Secure Wireless Home Network

In order to set up a secure, wireless home network, you will need to do the following:

Pre-Installation Checklist

Prior to installation, you will need:

1. A USB pen drive with at least 2 MB of free space.
2. A wireless Access Point (AP) or router connected to your LAN or Internet connection. Check the AP vendor's documentation on how to physically connect the device. Do not configure the AP at this point.
3. To determine which of your wireless devices (laptops, PCs etc) support Windows Connect Now technology.
4. To determine which method of authentication and encryption is supported by all your wireless devices including the AP, laptops, PCs, etc. The wireless devices must support either WPA-PSK/TKIP, which is the recommended protocol set, or open system/WEP. The latter is discouraged as it is a weak-security system. You will need to use open system/WEP if some of your devices do not support WPA-PSK/TKIP.
5. To ensure that if the computers have an external switch to turn on the wireless adapter, they are indeed turned on.
6. To ensure that Windows XP has been updated to Service Pack 2.
7. To configure all the wireless computers in your network for automatic addressing. To do that, open Network Connections, and under Wireless Connection, right-click and select Properties. Under the General tab, in the section "This connection uses the following items", select Internet Protocol (TCP/IP) and click Properties. In the resulting dialog box, under